

Assignment Brief: Transitioning to the Rights-Based Aged Care Act and Regulatory Framework

Course/Module: Balancing Duty of Care with Dignity of Risk

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research.**

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:

The Support at Home program will combine multiple existing aged care programs over time. Which two specific programs will be replaced first when it launches on July 1, 2025?

Question 2:

Under the new Support at Home fee structure, what percentage are older people required to contribute out-of-pocket for their clinical care services?

Question 3:

The new framework introduces a "no worse off" principle for those who were already receiving a home care package before September 12, 2024. What does this principle guarantee regarding their future contribution rates?

Question 4:

To help more older people pass away comfortably at home rather than in a hospital, a new end-of-life pathway has been created. What is the specific funding amount and timeframe allocated for this short-term pathway?

Question 5:

How much pre-approved funding is available for assistive technology and home modifications (such as installing handrails) so that older people do not have to save up their package funds for these necessities?

Question 6:

What specific conversational method is used in the newly established First Nations assessment pathway to ensure the process is culturally safe, minimizes retelling traumatic stories, and builds trust?

Question 7:

For the first 12 months of the Support at Home program, who is responsible for setting the prices for care services, and on what date will government-mandated price caps officially take effect?

Question 8:

When the independent regulator conducts reviews under the new Act, will their primary focus be on catching minor administrative errors, or on identifying high-risk issues that affect the safety and rights of older people?

Question 9:

Under the updated registration system, aged care providers are divided into six distinct categories. Which three specific provider categories are required to undergo formal audits by the commission?

Question 10:

If an aged care provider pays an external business (such as a third-party catering, cleaning, or physiotherapy company) to deliver government-funded services to an older person, what legal term is used to classify that external business?

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**, assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.